



Venturing into the Cloud? Develop a Customised Cloud Strategy First!

The magic of the cloud has touched everyone, directly or indirectly, though Indian companies are still treading carefully in this domain. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** speaks to **Rushikesh Jadhav, cloud evangelist, ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd**, on how the cloud has changed the way companies invest in their computing infrastructure and how they ought to prepare themselves for the coming days.

Rushikesh Jadhav,
cloud evangelist, ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd

Q The cloud is catching on in India. What trends are you seeing in the cloud space, which will affect users?

The cloud is bringing agility to physical infrastructure along with better resource management. Cloud users have the ability to demand resources whenever they want and from wherever they want. Users in India are very demanding and need a single point of contact for all their needs. The cloud has come up with the 'anything-as-a-service' model, leading to cost-effective solutions for everyone.

Cloud computing is probably the most cost effective way to use, maintain and upgrade IT infrastructure. Traditional desktop software and hardware cost companies a lot of money. The licensing fees for multiple users can prove to be very expensive for an establishment. But in the case of the cloud, this is available at much cheaper rates and, hence, can significantly lower the company's IT expenses. Besides, the pay-as-you-go model and the other scalable options available with cloud computing make it very reasonable for the company, especially with regard to licensing costs.

The consumption of cloud services is another vital factor. The emerging trend among users shows a higher rate of service consumption from mobile devices compared to desktops. Choosing the right cloud service provider can deliver savings, flexibility, performance and security.

Q For organisations that are already using the cloud, what should their next step be towards progressiveness and development?

It's apparent that many organisations have invested in a private or a public cloud to process workloads such as business applications, testing and development environments, as well as scalable e-commerce and social media applications. But going forward, it is likely that a sizeable chunk of this population will venture into the hybrid cloud. This is because the growing BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) trend and the easy availability of cloud storage services will make it easier to adopt capabilities suited for a mobile workforce.